

Israel launches attack on Iran

Netanyahu says strikes will go on ‘as long as necessary’

By Warren P. Strobel, John Hudson, Karen DeYoung, and Gerry Shih
WASHINGTON POST

Israel launched military strikes on Iran early Friday, potentially plunging the Middle East into a new round of violence and signaling the likely end for now of President Trump’s hopes for a negotiated peace deal to halt Tehran’s nuclear development.

In a video statement early Friday, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said, “This operation will continue for as many days as it takes to remove” what he called a “clear and present danger to Israel’s very survival.” Iran, he said, could “produce a nuclear weapon in a very short time. It could be a year. It could be a few months.”

Netanyahu said that Israeli aircraft

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Birchmore’s baby wasn’t suspect’s

DNA test rules out ex-detective accused of killing as the father

By Yvonne Abraham, Laura Crimaldi, and Gordon Russell
GLOBE STAFF

DNA testing has shown that the former Stoughton police detective accused of killing a pregnant Sandra Birchmore did not father the baby she was carrying, according to two people with knowledge of the case.

The people, who spoke on condition of anonymity, told the Globe that the analysis excludes Matthew Farwell as the father. A federal grand jury last August indicted him on a charge of killing Birchmore, to which he has pleaded not guilty.

It’s unclear if authorities have determined the child’s paternity. The results of other DNA tests in the case — on items from the scene, which could include Birchmore’s clothing, and the ligature found around her neck — are not yet publicly known.

How the findings will ultimately impact the case against Farwell is hard to say. Some experts said the findings could pose a challenge to prosecutors,

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HUNDREDS KILLED IN JET CRASH

An Air India flight bound for London crashed Thursday just seconds after takeoff in western India, leaving at least 241 people dead. Video showed the plane was in the air for less than a minute and descended slowly before erupting into a large fireball and plunging into a local medical college. Air India said everyone on the plane was killed, except for a British citizen who somehow was thrown clear. An unknown number of additional casualties were people on the ground. **A4.**

Pulling his team together

Chisholm lines up two dozen investors who want a piece of Celtics

By Shirley Leung
GLOBE STAFF

With the NBA Finals well underway, so is Bill Chisholm’s final push to buy the Boston Celtics.

COMMENTARY Chisholm — the North Shore native turned San Francisco-area private equity boss — may have made the headlines with his record-setting \$6.1 billion offer in March, but buying one of the premiere franchises in American sports isn’t as simple as writing one giant check.

Chisholm has spent the last few months curating a group of two dozen or so investors, chosen not just for their capital but for their ability to collaborate and offer industry ex-

pertise, such as in real estate, according to people briefed on the matter.

As lead owner, Chisholm will be the single biggest shareholder with at least a 15 percent stake, while global steel magnate Aditya Mittal is reportedly investing \$1 billion and will eventually serve as alternate governor. Private equity firm Sixth Street is expected to hold roughly a 10 percent stake in the team and be a silent partner, according to a person knowledgeable about the deal. But lots of other people will also have a slice of the team, and that’s where things can get more complicated.

Buying a pro sports team can be fiercely competitive, because these

teams so rarely change hands, and it’s often a complex, high-stakes transaction. The Grousbeck family, which has been the lead owner of the Celtics since 2002, shocked the sports world last July when it put the team up for sale just two weeks after the C’s clinched an NBA-leading 18th championship. Irv Grousbeck, the 90-year-old patriarch, is driving the sale of the franchise for estate planning purposes.

While each transaction is different, typically a wealthy individual leads a bid and puts together a collection of other well-resourced investors, often successful business titans. Sometimes these people know each other going in; other times

CELTICS, Page A9

Just a few bucks to help battle addiction

Small rewards show promise against stimulants

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Mercedes Pagan spent 13 years, nearly a third of her life, seeking treatment for her addiction to cocaine.

She tried detoxing four times at inpatient facilities but each time she was quickly discharged without follow-up care. She visited clinicians who specialize in addiction, but the only medications they could offer (methadone and buprenorphine) were for opioid addiction and are not effective for treating the use of stimulants like cocaine.

Nothing stuck until Pagan, a 36-year-old personal caregiver from Revere, learned late last year of an innovative new initiative at the Boston Health Care for the Homeless Program that gave her a financial incentive to stay sober. Every time she took a drug test that was free of cocaine, showed up for a recovery group meeting, or engaged in physical exercise, Pagan was rewarded with \$5 loaded onto a debit card.

While modest, the payments were enough to motivate Pagan to keep coming back, week after week, to a program that taught her new strategies for controlling her cravings.

“When you’re living on the edge, sometimes you need

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TGI dry day

Friday: Cooler but nice.
High 71-76. Low 56-61.

Saturday: Showers.
High 60-65. Low 52-57.

High tide: 1:03 a.m., 1:46 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:22

Weather and Comics, G6-7.
Obituaries, C11.



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

A federal judge issued a temporary restraining order directing President Trump to return control of the National Guard to California. **A7.**

A Harvard Medical School scientist from Russia was released after being detained since February. **B1.**

Sister Lida Christ (above) and other members of the Sisters of Perpetual Indulgence say they’ll be constantly transforming from ordinary to exotic during Pride Month. **G1.**

Thousands are expected to fill the streets Saturday for Boston’s 2025 Pride parade. **B1.**

Canada wildfire smoke poses increasing risks here

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

Canada is burning — again — and here in New England, the skies tell the story.

Right now, wildfires are raging across over 7 million acres of boreal forest in Western Canada, a continuous blanket of conifers and growth that covers much of the country and is particularly susceptible to changes in the climate, such as warmer temperatures and less snow or rain.

“When it ignites,” said Ryan Ness, adaptation research director at the Canadian Climate Institute, “it’s very hard to stop.”

Increasingly, that’s not just a problem for Canada but for New England and other distant locations because toxic

smoke from the fires, carrying minuscule particles of pollution, wafts into the atmosphere and is carried across thousands of miles. And with that smoke comes heightened health risks for vulnerable populations, like children, the elderly, and people with existing breathing conditions.

Air quality in Boston was in the “moderate” range for the middle of this week, though it hit “unhealthy” levels in the Boston area Thursday for people at heightened risk. Earlier this month, air quality in the Midwest reached “very unhealthy” levels, and smoke traveled as far as Europe.

Warmer winters, caused by an increase in greenhouse gases in the atmosphere, are turning

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